

ROWAN BRAD QUNI-GUDZINAS

Research systems builder

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Earlier work is published under **Brad Gudzin**as.

SUMMARY

Research and data leader who builds the systems behind the research. 15 years running national research programs and data products at the U.S. Federal Highway Administration and AARP. Founder of QNFO, an independent research imprint with an AI-assisted pipeline, a published audit method and a public correction trail. Open to research management, applied AI and research-integrity roles.

EXPERIENCE

Founder

QNFO (independent research) | 2024 to present

- Built and run an autonomous research system on Cloudflare (44 live workers) that drafts, referees, revises, versions, publishes and corrects papers.
- Publish an open library of preprints with DOIs (papers.qnfo.org) and a knowledge graph that other tools can query by API.
- Designed the audit method: The Universal Ignorance Audit and Epistemic Legibility in AI-Assisted Science.
- Proposed JPCUB, a whole-system energy benchmark for computing (joules per correct answer). Published the measurement protocol, estimates for 17 quantum platforms and an extension to LLM inference.

Executive Director and Founder

Empowering Change (nonprofit) | San Francisco, CA | 2023 to 2024

- Took the nonprofit from incorporation to public launch.
- Built an LLM legal-navigation tool for self-represented litigants: document drafting, procedural guidance and plain-language translation of legal terms.

Platform Data Product Manager

iManage | 2022 to 2023

Senior Product Manager

Epsilon (Publicis Groupe) | 2021 to 2022

Product Manager and Senior Methods Advisor

AARP Public Policy Institute | Washington, DC | 2016 to 2021

- Led the **AARP Livability Index**: 50+ data sources across 7 domains, scoring U.S. neighborhoods nationwide, across multiple public releases.
- Co-authored the Livability Index 2018 report and AARP policy work on housing affordability, including the 2016 analysis of Low-Income Housing Tax Credits.
- The Index and its method are cited in 20+ academic and policy studies.

Senior Data Scientist

The Advisory Board Company | 2016

Senior Associate, Data Analytics

Deloitte Consulting LLP | Washington, DC | 2015 to 2016

- Delivered analytics and machine-learning engagements for federal and public-sector clients.
- Co-authored a 2016 Transportation Research Board paper on updating the National Household Travel Survey with American Community Survey data.

Data Analyst and Research Manager

U.S. Department of Transportation, Federal Highway Administration | Washington, DC | 2011 to 2015

- Managed a \$1.5M+ federal research portfolio as a certified Contracting Officer's Representative: technical oversight, budgets, milestones and acceptance of contractor deliverables.
- Led technical components of the national Tour-Based Model System for long-distance passenger travel forecasting.
- Presented national long-distance travel data needs at the 2011 TRB National Household Travel Survey workshop.

Earlier roles

Role	Organization	Period
Consultant	IBI Group	2008 to 2011
Systems Planner	Delaware Valley Regional Planning Commission	2005 to 2008
GIS Analyst	Cross County Connection TMA	2004 to 2005

SELECTED WORK

1. AARP Livability Index 2018 report (co-author, as Brad Gudzinias)
2. Tour-Based National Model System, FHWA (2014, as Brad Gudzinias)
3. The Joules-per-Solution Metric: Definition, Measurement Protocol, and Anti-Gaming Provisions (2026)
4. Error Correction Is a Landauer Machine: The Thermodynamic Floor of Quantum Error-Correction Overhead (2026)
5. The Universal Ignorance Audit (2026)
6. Operating the Quniverse Fleet: Objectives, Successes, Failures, and Roadmap of an Autonomous Cloud Research System (2026)

Every QNFO paper is prepared with an AI-assisted research pipeline; the author is responsible for its content. Full library: papers.qnfo.org. All records: Zenodo.

EDUCATION

- **M.S., City and Regional Studies**, Rutgers University, Edward J. Bloustein School of Planning and Public Policy (2008)
- **B.A., Urban Studies and Community Planning**, Rutgers University-Camden (2004)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Project Management Professional (PMP), Project Management Institute (2016)
- Contracting Officer's Representative (COR), Defense Acquisition University (2011)
- American Institute of Certified Planners (AICP), American Planning Association (2009)

SKILLS

Research program management · federal contract oversight · product management · statistical and travel-demand modeling · GIS · LLM agent systems · Cloudflare Workers, D1, R2, Vectorize · Python, JavaScript, SQL